# Knowledge organiser (TRACK) — Critique, test and redirect the design

Pathway: TRACK · Week 4 Part 2 · Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

## Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How do we use a structured studio critique to spot a weak area and test one material fix?

• Audit your developing architectural relief panel against three criteria: structural balance, relief depth, and tonal contrast.

• Exchange one specific peer diagnostic using the 'Strength / Target / Test' protocol.

• Build a quick material test swatch before applying the improvement to your main panel.

## Essential vocabulary

• critique: A structured studio check that identifies strengths and specific next steps.

• diagnostic: Spotting the exact visual or structural reason why an area looks weak.

• redirect: Adjusting your plan or adding a layer to solve a design problem.

• swatch: A small test piece used to try a fix before putting it on your main artwork.

• focal joint: The main structural intersection where beams meet and draw the eye.

## Three-step studio method

Step 1: Run the two-metre stand-up audit: I prop my panel up, step back, and note on my critique card: 'Strength: strong arch. Target: left pillar blends into background.'

Step 2: Build a 6 cm test swatch: On a small greyboard scrap, I test adding a corrugated backing strip and a bright chalk flange line.

Step 3: Apply the verified upgrade to the panel: Seeing the swatch pop, I laminate the ridged strip and chalk edge onto my main panel's left pillar.